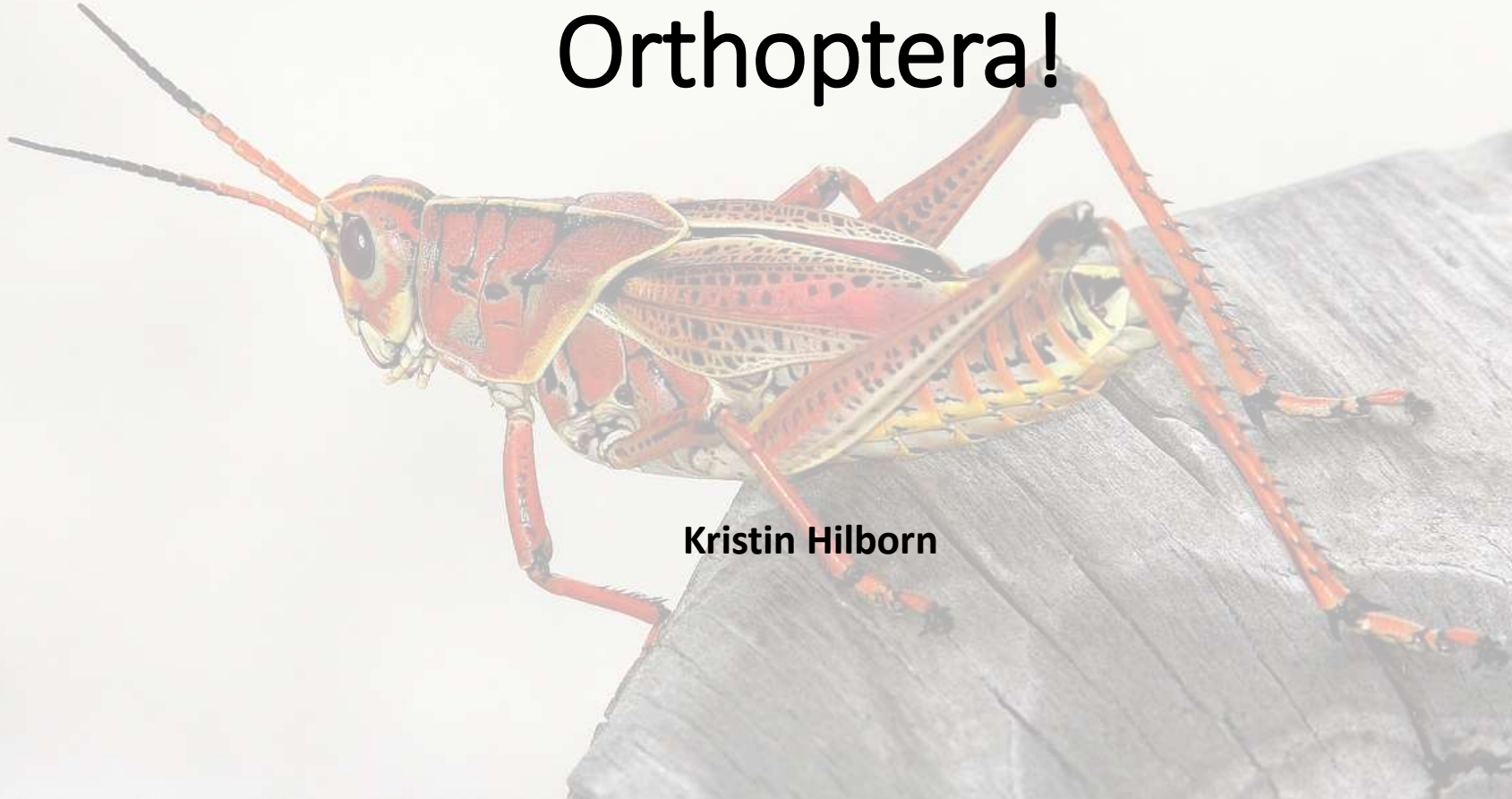


Exam 2 Orders of the Day

Orthoptera!

Kristin Hilborn



Orthoptera

- “Straight-winged”
- ~ 300 million years old

Katydid & Crickets (Ensifera)

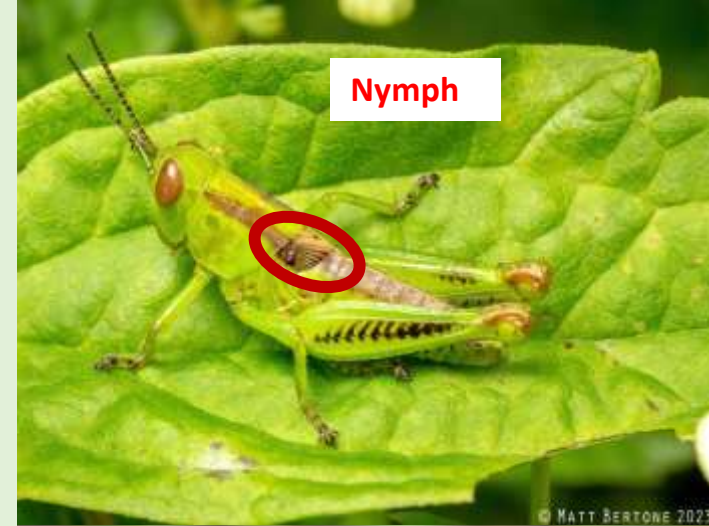


Grasshoppers and Pigmy
Mole Crickets (Caelifera)



Hemimetabola

- Incomplete metamorphosis
- Egg → Nymph (several stages) → Adult
- Nymphs molt many times prior to adulthood
- Nymphs look very similar to adults; however, lack developed wings and reproductive organs
 - Developing wing pads are often visible in nymphs



Neoptera... the beginning of something new

“Neo-” [New] = “Ptery”[Wing]

A new wing folding mechanism that allows a new resting position

- Prior to Orthopterans wings could only be held upright or outwards

Before



After



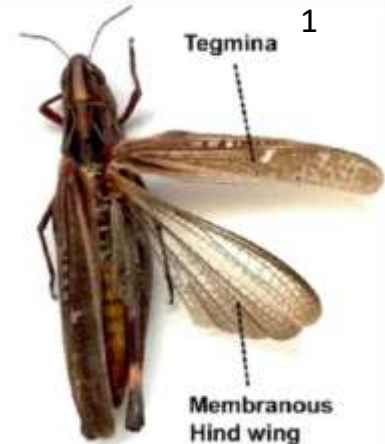
Orthoptera Characteristics

- Modified hind legs for jumping
- Mandibulate mouth parts
- Filiform antennae
- Forewing is leathery (tegmina) which covers membranous hind wing
- Cerci short and unsegmented
- Something called a Tympanum

Saltatorial - (Saltatorial =
Leaping ; Jumping Leg)



ANTENNAE



Orthoptera Characteristics

- Mostly Herbivorous
 - Some species “eat toxic plants, and keep the toxins in their bodies for protection”²
 - Few are carnivorous
- More than 25,000 species that are known today²
- Primarily solitary but some migratory species will gather in large numbers
- Most active during the day but still around at night
- Often lays eggs underground



²Web, A. D. (n.d.). *Critter Catalog*. BioKIDS. <http://www.biokids.umich.edu/critters/Acrididae/>

Fun Fact!

Orthopterans can be very large!

- The Giant Wētā can get up to 71g which is approx. 3x heavier than a mouse²
- Also, it's protected by law due to its risk of extinction



²*Top 10 largest insects in the world.* BBC Science Focus Magazine. (n.d.). <https://www.sciencefocus.com/nature/largest-insects-in-the->

[https://youtu.be/jWx1wPKAkpc?
si=QubvHUJYjx7sPMWv](https://youtu.be/jWx1wPKAkpc?si=QubvHUJYjx7sPMWv)



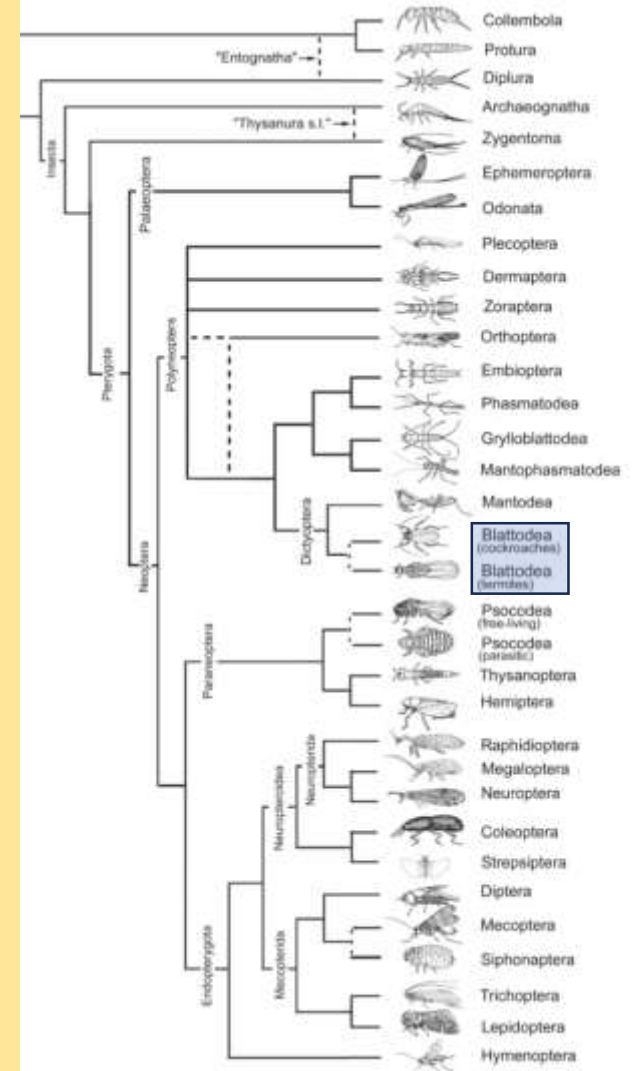


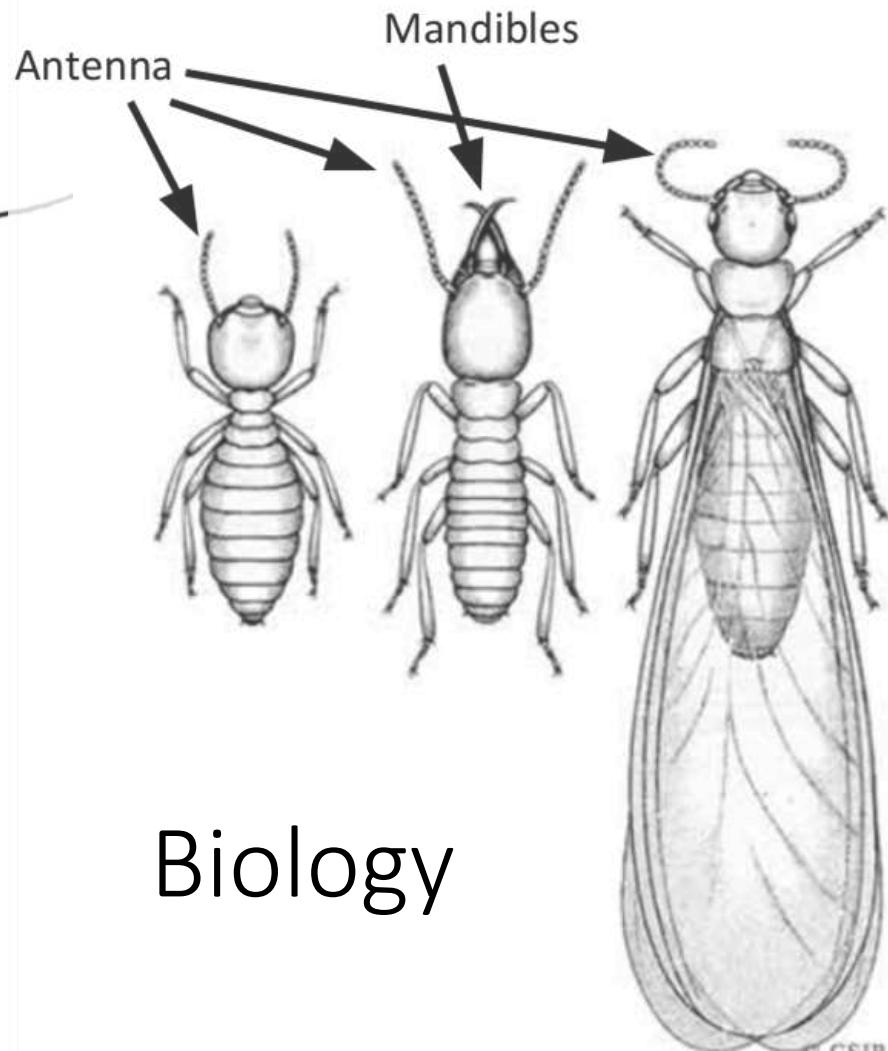
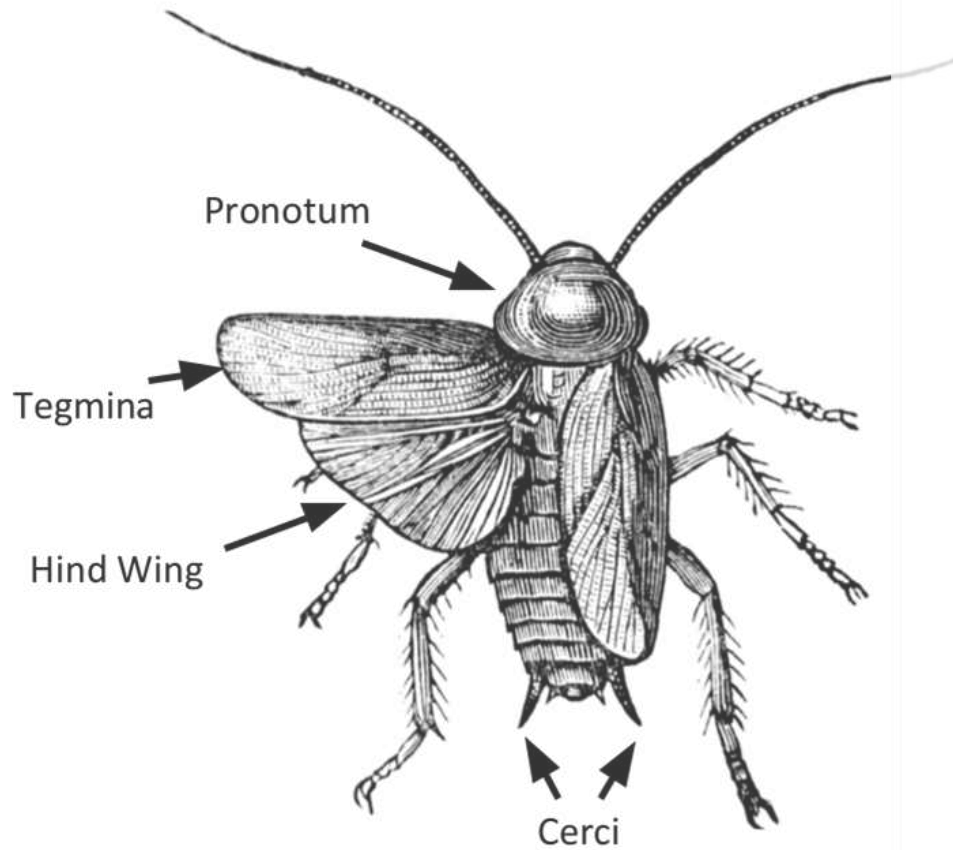
Blattodea & Isoptera

Alexis Alsdorf

Blattodea – Cockroaches and Termites

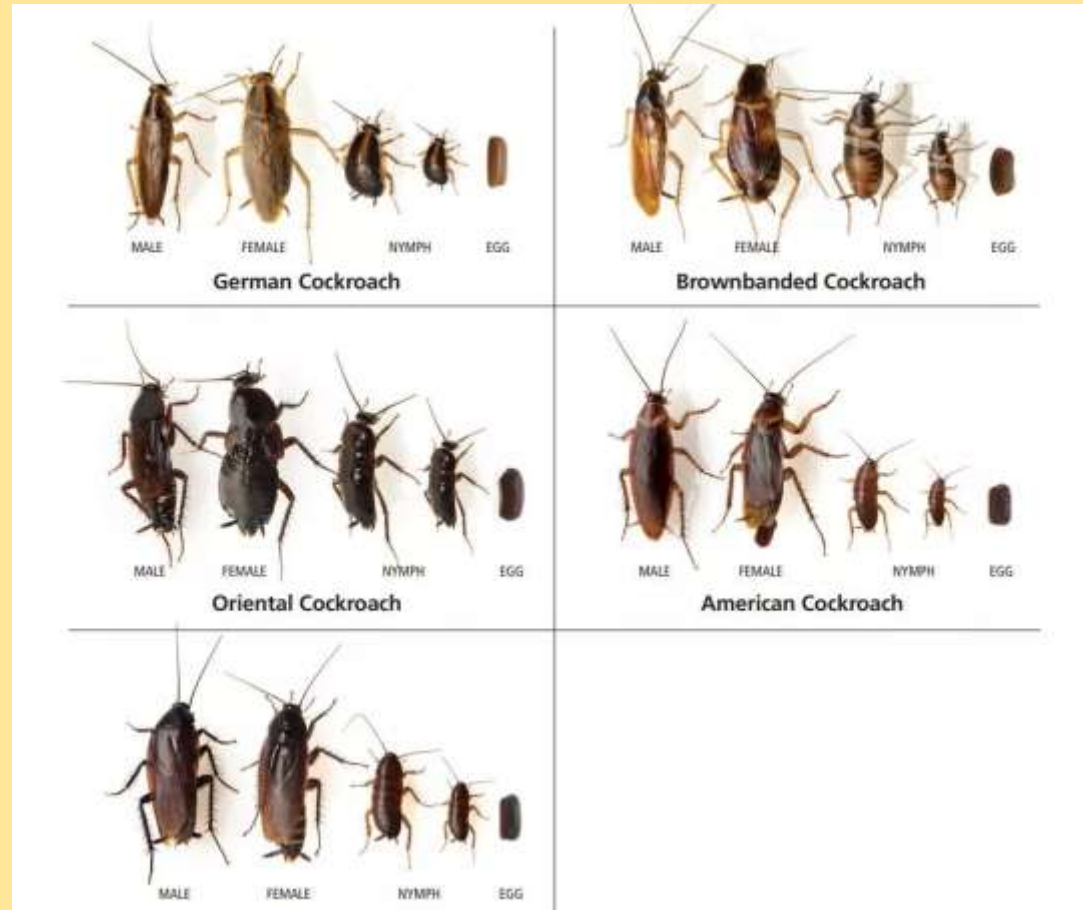
- “Blatta” – an insect that shuns the light
- Isoptera – 2007-2018
 - “iso” – equal
 - “ptera” - wings
- ~4,600 classified species of cockroach
- ~3,000 classified species of termites





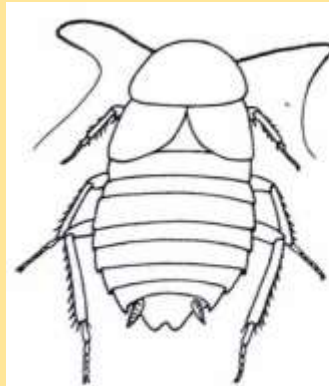
Cockroaches

- Hemimetabolous – incomplete metamorphosis
 - Eggs, nymphs, adults
- Ootheca
 - “oo” - egg
 - “theca” - receptacle
- Food
 - Leaf litter/Detritus
 - Wood
 - Last night’s dinner
 - Hair
 - Something with nutrition

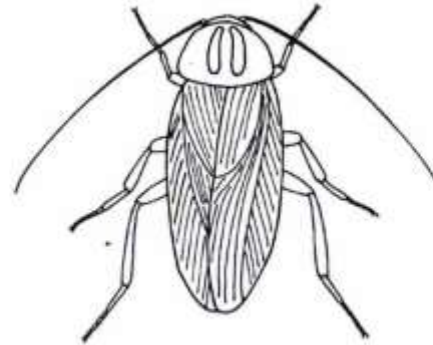


Cockroaches

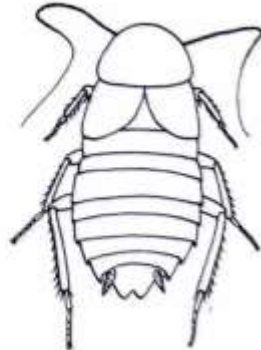
- Interesting behaviors
 - Nuptial gifts
 - Tergal gland - produces a “treat” for the interested female
 - Kin recognition
 - Shared nest sites (aggregations) guided by pheromones
 - Some exhibit parental care
 - Fecal trail navigation
- Not all are pests



AMERICAN ROACH



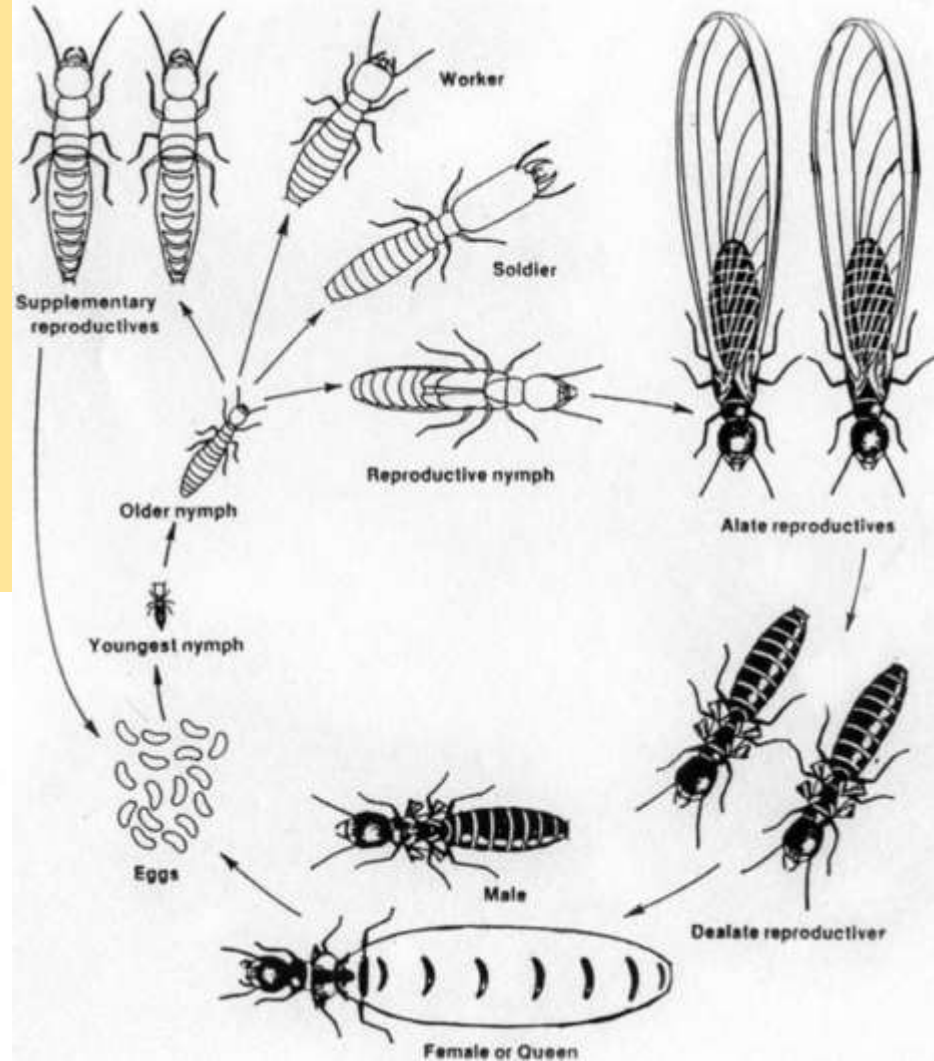
GERMAN ROACH



ORIENTAL ROACH

Termites (used to be Isoptera)

- Evolved ~170 – 54 mya
- Hemimetabolous
- “Eusocial Cockroaches”
 - Cooperative brood care
 - Division of labor
 - Overlapping generations
- “caste system”
 - Queen
 - King
 - Secondary Queen
 - Tertiary Queen
 - Soldiers
 - Workers



Termites

- Gut microbiome
 - Extremely diverse and dense
 - Breaks down wood
- Cellulose-based habitat





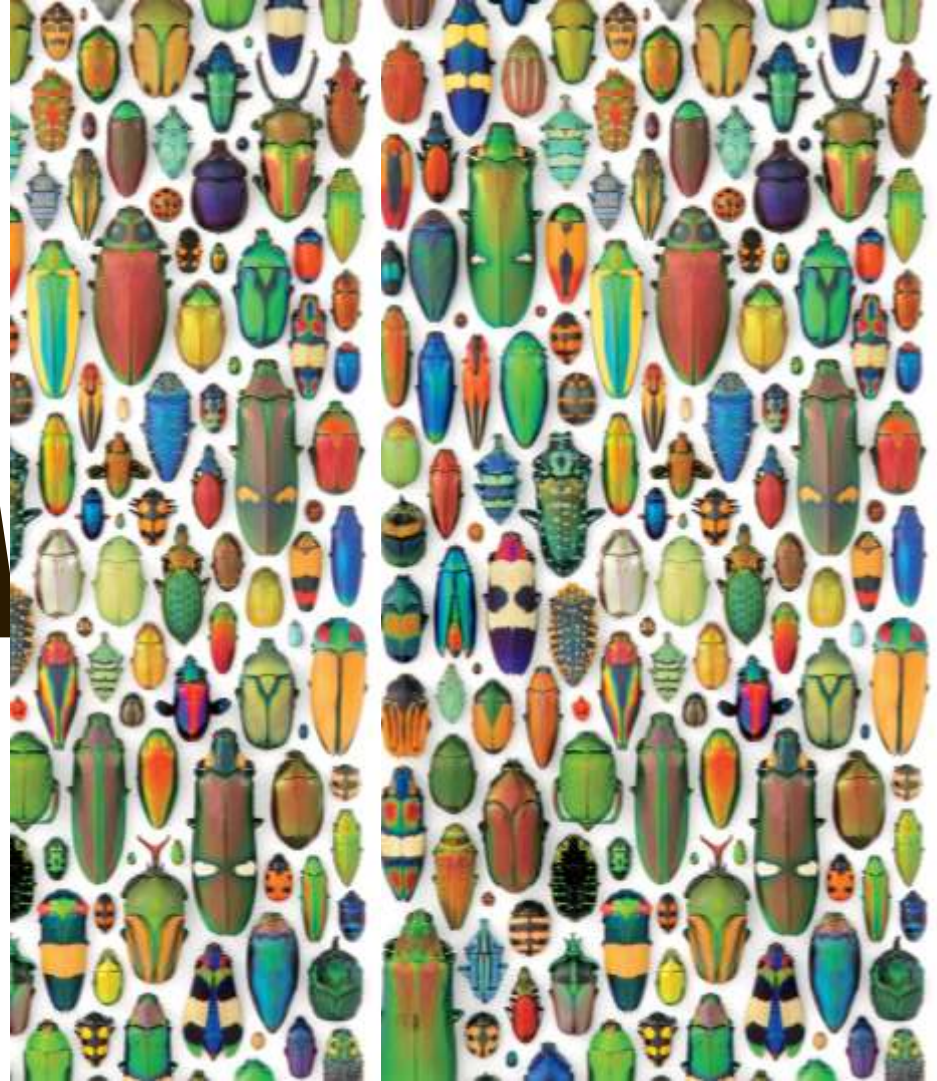
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=620omdSZzBs>

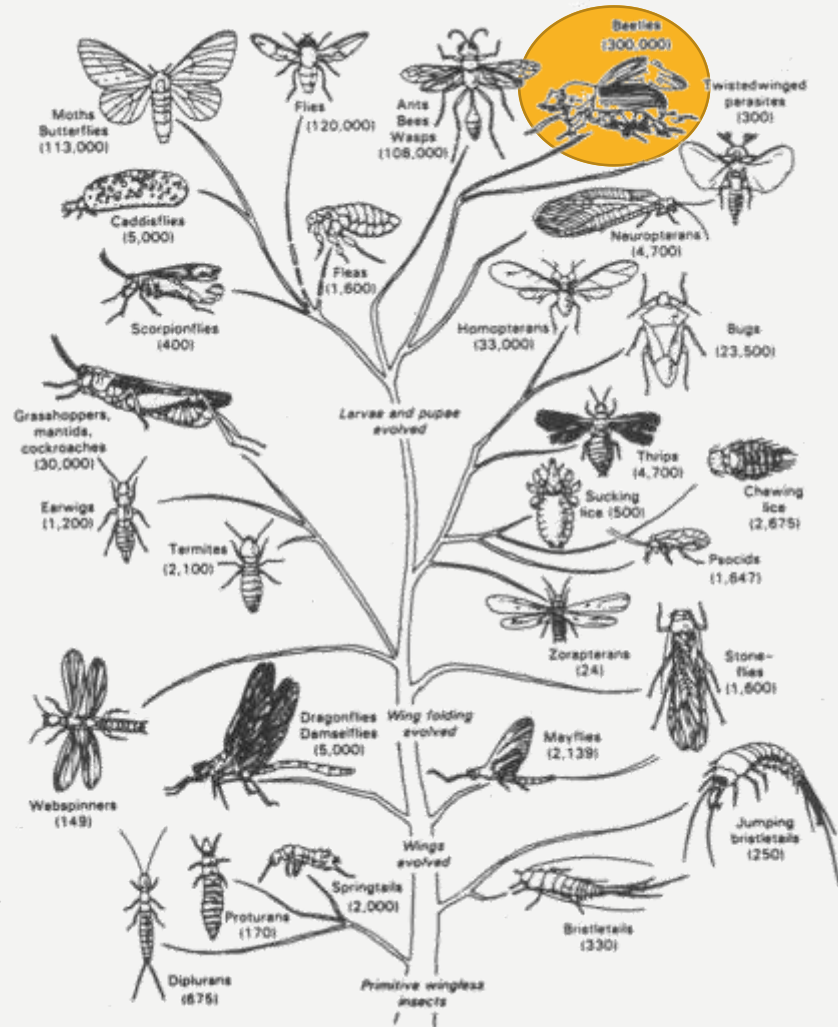
Ent 201

Order of the Day Presentation:

COLEOPTERA

TAYNARA POSSEBOM

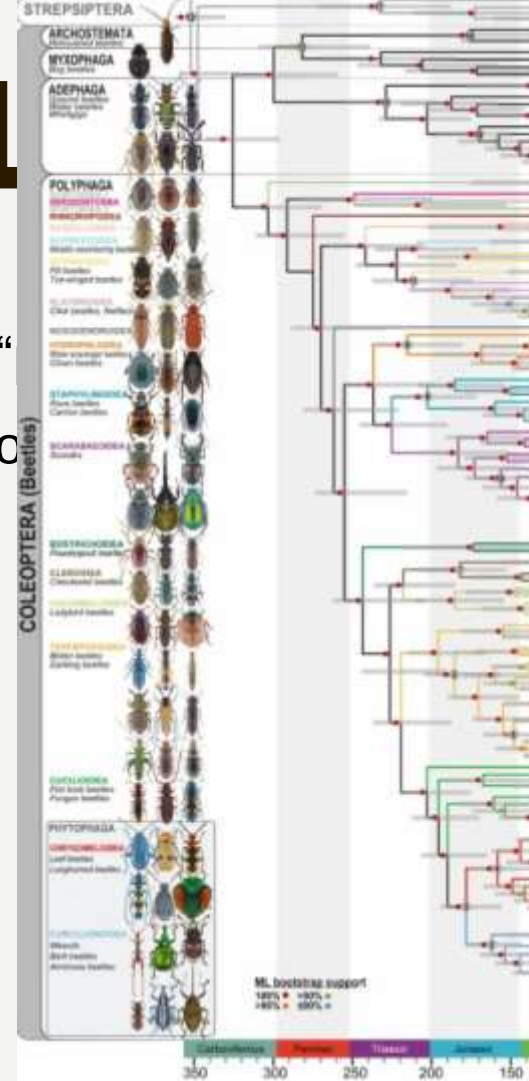




OH, TO KNOW A BEETLE

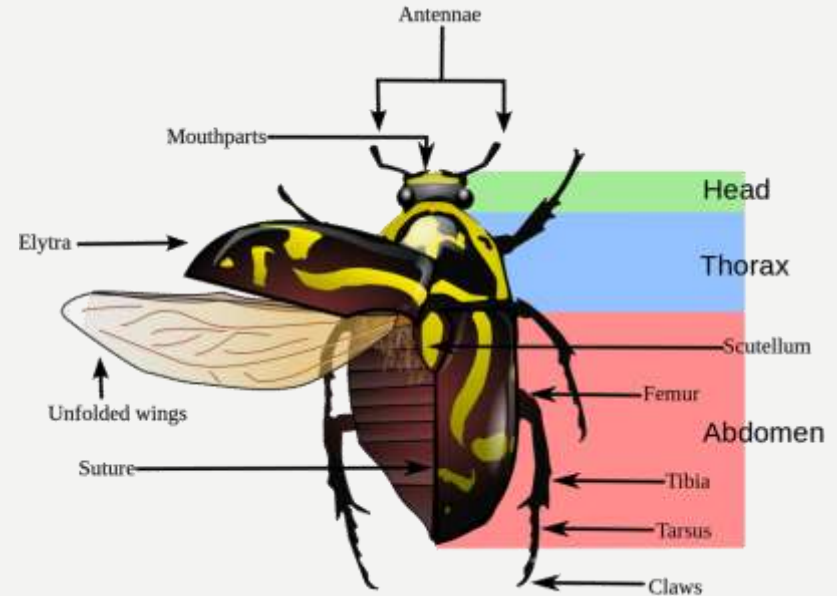
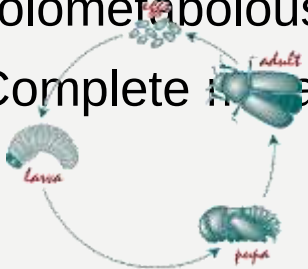
- Originated from Greek → “koleos” – *sheath* and “
- Stepped onto the scene ~285mya (Permian period)
- Largest insect order (description bias)
 - ~400,000 described species
 - Next largest with ~180,000 species

Oldest
crown-
group
fossil ~230
Ma old



THE BEETLE BODY & DEVELOPMENT

- Characterized by their hardened forewing → The Elytra
 - Their delicate hind wings are tightly folded under the elytra, waiting for flight!
- Scutellum is the top plate (tergite) of their mesothorax
- Holometabolous
- Complete metamorphosis



THE “SUPER” FAMILIES

- The order Coleoptera is subdivided into many super families
 - Often these groups are **INCREDIBLY** large, and can be **HIGHLY** diverse
- Examples:
 - Curculionidae (Weevils) → ~97,000 species
 - Staphylinidae (Rove Beetles) → ~67,000 species
 - Tenebrionidae (Darkling Beetles) → ~20,000 species



Curculio occidentis (Oak Weevil)

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Paederus spp. (Highly inflammatory hemolymph)

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A lot more!



Asbolus verrucosus (B-Death Feigning Beetle)

MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

- Diverse Morphologies!
 - Antenna (*Rhipiceridae* – Cedar Beetles)
 - Legs (Harlequin Beetle)
 - Pronotum/Thorax (Rhinoceros/Stag Beetle; Giraffe Weevil)

MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

- Diverse Morphologies!

Antennae (*Rhipiceridae* – Cedar



MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

- Diverse Morphologies
 - Legs (Harlequin B)

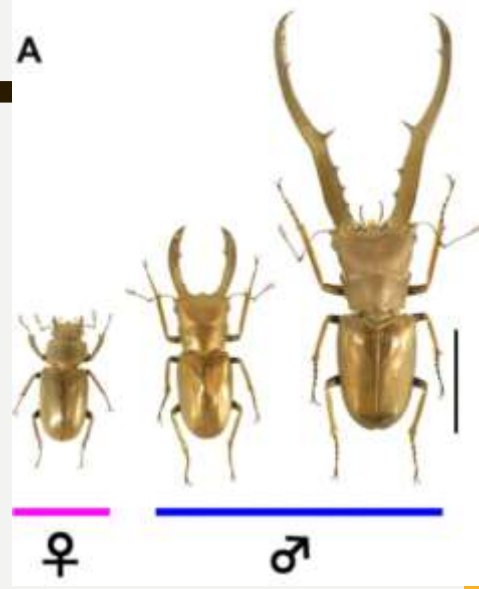


MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

- Diverse Morphologies!

– Pronotum/Thorax

(Rhinoceros/Stag Beetle: Giraffe



MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

Diverse Habitats/Food

Carnivores

Plant feeders

Parasitoids (Rhipiphori

Dung/Detritus



MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

Diverse Habitats/Food

Carnivores

Plant feeders

Parasitoids (Rhipiphori

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MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

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MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

Diverse Habitats/Food

Carnivores

Plant feeders

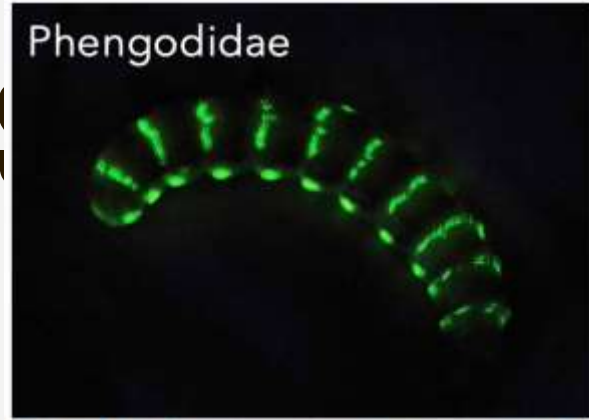
Parasitoids (Rhipiph

Dung/Detritus



MASTERS OF DIVERSITY

- Three beetle families exhibit **bioluminescence**



BEETLES IN YOUR BACKYARD

- Many species overlap with humans in both positive and negative ways, some you already know!



Ladybug →
Coccinellidae

An excellent beetle to have present in gardens due to it is



Dung Beetle →
Scarabs

Responsible for keeping our world from piling up with



CPB →
Chrysomelidae

An incredibly tenacious and resistant pest



Boll Weevil →
Curculionidae
Major pest of cotton, whose eradication was achieved through an incredible effort!

THE COOL BEETLES!

- The order Coleoptera has also had a major impact on society, pop culture, food, and technology!



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BIOTECHNOLOGY

The Army's Remote-Controlled Beetle

The insect's flight path can be wirelessly controlled via a neural implant.

By Emily Singer

January 29, 2009



IS THIS AFRICAN INSECT THE STRONGEST IN THE WORLD?

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4hXe3t1b3k>

THE GREAT DIVING BEETLE UNDERWATER HUNTER!

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hwqja6FWUZA>



QUESTIONS?

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